REASON, REVELATION AND FAITH

THREE OFFICES → REASON'S FUNCTIONS → THE TWO MIDDLE TERMS → REVELATION'S TWO AXES → PROPOSITIONAL MODEL → ENCOUNTER MODEL → AUTHENTICATION → CIRCULARITY AND DIVERSITY → SEVEN TENETS → FAITH AGAINST BELIEF → AQUINAS → KIERKEGAARD'S LADDER → JUSTIFICATION → MIRACLES → SCIENCE AND RELIGION → INDIAN BENCH AND THE ANSWER RAIL

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final synthesis. Each card uses a layout chosen for its own content; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW
● SUBORDINATE EXTRA
● APPROVAL / REVIEW

Generated in place for the Philosophy of Religion sequential repair; all prior artifacts unchanged and this package remains unapproved.

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

THE ONE QUESTION AND THE THREE EPISTEMIC OFFICES

THREE PRINTED TERMS
REASON ARGUES
REVELATION DISCLOSES
FAITH TRUSTS
REDUCTIONISM
UNAUTHENTICATED AUTHORITY
ARBITRARINESS OR FANATICISM
MUTUAL AUDIT, NOT HIERARCHY

REASON tests warrant -> REVELATION claims disclosure -> FAITH receives and commits

reason alone -> reductionism | revelation alone -> unauthenticated authority | faith alone -> arbitrariness

THE SYLLABUS CLAUSE AND WHAT IT OWNS

- Syllabus item 5, verbatim: 'Reason, Revelation and Faith.'
- The clause owns the epistemic roles and relations of the three terms, their models of warrant, the authentication of a revelation-claim, committed reception, and the Indian-Western comparison.

THREE JOBS, NOT THREE RIVALS

- Reason is an activity of assessment and interpretation; revelation is an alleged event or content; faith is a mode of reception and commitment.
- Reason's jurisdiction includes probabilistic, abductive, critical and hermeneutic work, not deductive proof alone.

THE FIREWALL

- Detailed proofs for God belong to the Proofs owner; the phenomenology of religious experience to the Religious Experience owner; meaning and falsification to the Religious Language owner; full pluralist theory to the Religious Pluralism owner.
- Miracles enter only as support for a revelation-claim, never as a substitute for the epistemic analysis.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each office corrects the characteristic excess of the others, which is why the defensible account is a division of labour under mutual audit.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The philosophical problem is not whether religion may use only one source, but how rational inquiry, disclosed authority and committed trust can operate together without either contradiction or arbitrariness.

01

STAGE 01

REASON: FIVE FUNCTIONS AND THE ONE LIMIT

NATURAL THEOLOGY
COHERENCE TEST
HERMENEUTICS
APOLOGETICS
REGULATION
EXCEEDS, NEVER CONTRADICTS
PREAMBLES OF FAITH
INFERENCE TO ISVARA

THE FOUR PRINTED FUNCTIONS

- Reason constructs natural theology, that is, the proofs for God; Aquinas' preambles and the Nyaya inference to God (Isvara) are the standard instances.
- It tests the coherence of doctrines, so that no appeal to mystery can make a contradiction true.
- It interprets scripture, distinguishing literal, analogical and historically conditioned senses.
- It defends faith, which is apologetics, and correlatively criticises.

THE FIFTH FUNCTION, WHICH CARRIES THE 2021 MARKS

- Regulation is the power to veto contradiction, weigh testimony, discipline interpretation and identify defeaters.
- It survives even for a reader who thinks every proof fails, which is why scepticism about natural theology does not retire reason from religion.

SCOPE AND LIMIT

- Natural theology argues toward theological conclusions; philosophy of religion additionally analyses language, experience and warrant, and may reach negative conclusions.
- Clifford states the rationalist demand: it is wrong always, everywhere, and for anyone, to believe anything upon insufficient evidence.
- Kant restricts speculative reason beyond possible experience; natural theologians reply that metaphysical inference concerns the conditions of experience rather than a further observed object.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The limit must be written as exceeding rather than contradicting, because the entire defensibility of the position rests on that single word.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Reason's religious work is not exhausted by proof: it constructs, tests, interprets and defends, and it is precisely the last three functions that survive the failure of the first.

02

STAGE 02

THE TWO MIDDLE TERMS THAT DECIDE THE MARKS

REGULATIVE
CONSTITUTIVE
SUPRA-RATIONAL
IRRATIONAL
DEFEASIBILITY
CRITICAL RATIONALISM
INSULATED FIDEISM
THIS CLAUSE PUNISHES BINARIES

REGULATIVE AGAINST CONSTITUTIVE

- Regulation is negative and occasion-bound: it vetoes contradiction, weighs testimony, disciplines reading and names defeaters.
- Constitution would be productive: it would supply the distinctive content of the belief.
- The asymmetry is real, because reason can rule out an incoherent doctrine of God without being able to produce the doctrine of the Trinity.

RATIONAL, SUPRA-RATIONAL, IRRATIONAL

- Faith's rational side is grounds, coherence and cumulative evidence; its supra-rational side is trust, commitment and the step beyond proof.
- Supra-rational exceeds what proof establishes; irrational contradicts coherence or defies decisive evidence.
- Without the middle term, every claim that outruns proof is irrational by definition and the 2023 question convicts religion before it is argued.

THE PRICE OF THE MIDDLE SEAT

- Critical rationalism permits committed belief while keeping it open to criticism and defeaters.
- A belief that no possible consideration could count against has purchased safety by leaving the epistemic conversation, which is why Plantinga insists his properly basic belief remains defeasible.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Both binaries have the same shape, and in each the examinable answer is the middle column that a weak script never reaches.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Reason is regulative but not constitutive of religious belief: it can veto incoherence, discipline interpretation and assess evidence, but it does not generate the content that faith receives.

03

STAGE 03

REVELATION ON TWO INDEPENDENT AXES

GENERAL REVELATION
SPECIAL REVELATION
PROPOSITIONAL
NON-PROPOSITIONAL
SCOPE AND MEDIUM
WHAT REVELATION IS
NOT ONE LADDER
INSPIRATION IS NOT REVELATION

SCOPE \ NATURE	PROPOSITIONAL: truths communicated	NON-PROPOSITIONAL: God's acts and self-presence
GENERAL: available in principle to all	nature and conscience read as conveying truths about God	the world experienced as gift, presence or address
SPECIAL: tied to a particular event, person, text or community	scripture, prophet or tradition delivering doctrine for assent; Aquinas' mysteries	a particular history received as divine action; doctrine is the community's interpretation; Hick's experiencing-as

WHY THE AXES ARE INDEPENDENT

- The general and special distinction concerns scope and medium, that is, who can access the disclosure and through what.
- The propositional and non-propositional distinction concerns what revelation is: truth-content, or divine self-disclosure in an event.
- They cross each other, so every cell of the grid is occupied and no single ladder can represent both.

THREE WORDS THAT ARE NOT SYNONYMS

- Revelation is the disclosure itself.
- Inspiration concerns the divine and human authorship of the record.
- Infallibility concerns freedom from error in the result. The three can come apart, and conflating them is a standing examiner trap.

WHAT THE GRID BUYS IN THE EXAM

- Any example can be placed in a single move, which makes the 2025 fifteen-marker mechanical rather than exploratory.
- Collapsing the two axes makes natural and revealed theology indistinguishable from general and special revelation, and the question then cannot be answered.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Placing an example on both axes at once is the fastest available demonstration that the candidate controls the classification rather than reciting it.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Revelation is classified twice over, by the scope of its availability and by whether it is truth communicated or presence disclosed, and the two classifications are independent.

04

STAGE 04

PROPOSITIONAL REVELATION: NATURAL AGAINST REVEALED THEOLOGY

DIVINELY AUTHORISED TRUTHS
REVEALED THEOLOGY
NATURAL THEOLOGY
MYSTERIES
PREAMBLES
EPISTEMIC ACCESS
AUTHORLESS VEDA
CIRCULAR AUTHENTICATION

God can disclose -> prophets and scripture mediate -> signs, testimony and coherence warrant reception -> doctrine articulates the content

THE TWO STOREYS, DEFINED BY WHERE THE PREMISES COME FROM

- Natural theology argues from publicly accessible premises; its content is what reason alone can reach, paradigmatically that God exists and some divine attributes. Aquinas calls these the preambles of faith.
- Revealed theology proceeds from premises taken to be delivered; on the propositional view its content is the mysteries, such as the Trinity and the Incarnation.
- The distinction is one of epistemic access, not of importance, not of rationality and not of chronology.

THE PRESUPPOSITION, STATED HONESTLY

- A personal God acts in history and reliable transmission of the disclosure is possible.
- Signs, testimony and coherence are offered as warrant for reception, not as demonstration of divine origin.

THE INDIAN COMPLICATION THAT EARNS MARKS

- Mimamsa holds the Veda to be authorless (apauruseya): it is authoritative but is not a creator God's speech.
- So propositional scriptural authority and divine dictation are separable ideas, and India supplies a form of scriptural authority with no revealer at all.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the two theologies differ only in the source of their premises, revealed theology is not less rational but differently sourced, and saying so is what the 2025 stem rewards.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Natural theology is what reason reaches on its own; revealed theology is what the propositional model says reason could only receive, so the distinction is a claim about epistemic access rather than about religious importance.

05

STAGE 05

NON-PROPOSITIONAL REVELATION AND EXPERIENCING-AS

RELIGIOUS AMBIGUITY
EXPERIENCING-AS
CONCEPT-LADEN EXPERIENCE
INTERPRETIVE SCHEME
PROJECTION
RECEPTION NOT OCCURRENCE
HICK
DOCTRINAL DIVERSITY

AMBIGUOUS EVENT -> FAITH PERCEIVES IT AS DIVINE ACTION -> COMMUNITY CONCEPTUALISES -> DOCTRINE

break-points: the event did not occur | the perceiving is projection | the community invented it | doctrine is merely human

THE DOCTRINE AND ITS FOUR STEPS

- Revelation is primarily divine self-disclosure in events and encounter, and propositions are human interpretations of that disclosure.
- Events are religiously ambiguous; faith perceives them as divine action; communities conceptualise the encounter; doctrinal diversity then reflects differing interpretive schemes.
- A revelatory event names an experienced-as structure, not a property visible on the face of the occurrence: one and the same event bears a secular causal description and a providential one.

THE OBJECTION AND HICK'S REPLY

- If interpretation constitutes revelation, projection threatens, because the community may be reading its own wishes into a neutral world.
- Hick appeals to moral and spiritual transformation and to the resistance of reality to arbitrary interpretation.
- Neither reply is decisive, and stating that openly is worth more than pretending otherwise.

THE 2022 VERDICT STRUCTURE

- Concede the propositional point: divinely communicated content would be true whether or not it is received.
- Then hold the line: unreceived content is not revelation in anyone's religious life, so faith is indispensable to reception and efficacy rather than to objective occurrence.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The chain converts a slogan into an argument, because each of its four joints is exactly where a named objection attaches.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: On the non-propositional account an event does not carry its own religious meaning on its surface: the same occurrence is a natural process to one observer and a divine act to another, and faith is the difference.

06

STAGE 06

SIX AUTHENTICATION TESTS AND THEIR BUILT-IN LIMITS

MOTIVES OF CREDIBILITY
TESTIMONY
COHERENCE
MORAL FRUIT
TRADITION
MIRACLE-SIGN
CROSS-REVELATION
NO TEST IS NEUTRAL

TEST	WHAT IT ASKS	ITS BUILT-IN LIMIT
Source and testimony	is the witness competent, sincere, suitably placed and independently supported?	testimony transmits error as well as truth
Coherence	does the claim contradict itself or secure knowledge?	coherence does not establish divine origin
Moral and spiritual fruit	does reception produce truthfulness, compassion and transformation?	useful effects can occur under false beliefs
Tradition and community	has the interpretation been publicly transmitted, criticised and corrected?	communal endurance may preserve power or bias
Experience and miracle-sign	is there an event resistant to ordinary explanation and fitted to the message?	an unusual occurrence authenticates no single interpretation
Cross-revelation comparison	how does the claim answer rival disclosures and the diversity defeater?	the criteria are rarely neutral between traditions

WHY THE LIMIT COLUMN IS THE ANSWER

- The 2024 stem asks what kind of epistemic justifications are possible and adds 'with your own comments', so a bare list of criteria answers only half of it.
- Ranking the six, and defending the ranking, is the first-person assessment the directive is buying.

THE HONEST VERDICT FORMULA

- A revelation-claim is warranted, if at all, by a convergence of internal coherence, moral fruits, the recipient's experience, communal transmission and congruence with reason.
- No member of the convergence is decisive, and none is neutral between traditions.

THE OBJECTION FROM WEAKNESS

- If every test is defeasible, justification may look so weak that any tradition passes.
- Weak criteria still discriminate: a claim failing coherence, producing no moral fruit, resting on one uncorroborated witness and unable to survive comparison is worse off than one that survives all four.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each row is useless without its limit, because the limits are what convert a checklist into an evaluative argument.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A revelation-claim is warranted, if at all, by a convergence of defeasible criteria, no one of which is decisive and none of which is neutral between traditions.

07

STAGE 07

CIRCULARITY, RIVAL REVELATION AND THE DIVERSITY HANDOVER

VICIOUS CIRCLE
VIRTUOUS WEB
RECIPROCAL SUPPORT
HERMENEUTICS
RIVAL SCRIPTURES
REVISIONARY REPLY
DIVERSITY DEFEATER
HANDOVER TO PLURALISM

THE CIRCULARITY CHARGE AND ITS TEST

- Using a scripture's own claim to prove that same scripture's unique authority is circular unless independent testimony, coherence or other defeasible support is supplied.
- Many epistemic practices use reciprocal support, so the live question is whether this circle is vicious or a coherent web.
- Scripture requires interpretation, and authority does not eliminate hermeneutics.

COMPETING REVELATION

- Rival scriptures cannot all be literally infallible in incompatible claims.
- The standard reply distinguishes a core disclosure from historically conditioned interpretation, and critics fairly call that move revisionary because it rewrites what a tradition took itself to be claiming.

WHERE THE CLAUSE HANDS OVER

- Competing revelation is used here only as an authentication and diversity defeater; the complete pluralist theory and the absolute-truth debate belong to the Religious Pluralism owner.
- The residual difficulty, once justification is located inside a practice, is diversity rather than evidential poverty.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Stating the criterion for viciousness converts a defensive reply into an argument, because it says in advance what would make the circle fatal.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A circle of authentication is vicious only when it is the sole support offered, and the real cost of answering it is that religious diversity, not evidential poverty, becomes the live objection.

08

STAGE 08

FAITH: THE SEVEN TENETS AS A LADDER

ULTIMATE OBJECT
ASSENT
TRUST
COMMITMENT
HOPE
COMMUNITY
FRUITS
NEVER CONTENTLESS FEELING

ultimate object -> assent -> TRUST -> commitment -> hope -> community -> fruits

steps 1-2 are shared with belief | step 3 is the departure | steps 4-7 belief never supplies

THE SEVEN TENETS, AS THE STEM ASKS FOR THEM

- An object held to be ultimate; assent to some content about it; trust exceeding the available evidence.
- Commitment of the will with consequent risk; hope oriented to a future not yet secured.
- A community and tradition that transmits and disciplines it; and fruits, a transformed pattern of life by which it is tested.

WHY THE LADDER SHAPE MATTERS

- The first two rungs are shared with ordinary belief, which is why faith cannot be defined by contrast with content.
- Trust is the rung at which faith departs from belief, and the four rungs above it are what belief alone never supplies.

THE STANDING TRAP

- Defining faith as belief without evidence contradicts tenet two and makes the second half of the 2020 stem unanswerable.
- Faith is never contentless feeling; it always carries assent to something.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The ladder is not decoration: it shows exactly where belief stops and faith continues, which is the structural claim the distinction rests on.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Faith is constituted cumulatively, and the rung at which it parts from belief is trust rather than content, which is why it cannot be defined as belief with the evidence removed.

09

STAGE 09

FAITH AGAINST BELIEF: SIX AXES AND THE NAMED SUPPORTS

BELIEVE THAT
BELIEVE IN
FIDES QUAE CREDITUR
FIDES QUA CREDITUR
ULTIMATE CONCERN
I-THOU
BETRAYAL NOT FALSEHOOD
SRADDHA

AXIS	BELIEF	FAITH
Object	a proposition	a person, reality or ultimate
Grammar	believe THAT	believe IN, trust
Mode	cognitive assent	assent plus trust, commitment and risk
Voluntariness	largely involuntary	engages the will; faith can be given
Failure-mode	falsehood	betrayal, infidelity, apostasy
Degrees	degrees of confidence	degrees of fidelity and depth

THE NAMED WESTERN SUPPORTS

- Aquinas' pair: the faith which is believed (fides quae creditur), that is the content or creed, and the faith by which one believes (fides qua creditur), that is the act and disposition.
- Wilfred Cantwell Smith, Faith and Belief (1979), on the modern narrowing of 'belief' from a word closer to 'hold dear'.
- Tillich: faith is being grasped by an ultimate concern, whose characteristic failure is idolatry rather than unbelief. Buber: the I-Thou relation cannot be reduced to I-It propositions.

THE INDIAN ADVANTAGE ON THIS QUESTION

- The Gita 17.2-3 grades trust (sraddha) as sattvika, rajasa or tamasa and states that a person is constituted by their trust.
- In Advaita pedagogy trust is the disposition that makes inquiry possible and is replaced by realisation rather than preserved as belief.
- Buddhist trust (Pali saddha) is provisional and verification-directed: the Kalama Sutta, Anguttara Nikaya 3.65, counsels testing a teaching in experience rather than accepting it on report, lineage, scripture, logic or authority.

OBJECTION AND REPLY

- Objection: 'believing in' reduces to believing that something exists and is trustworthy.
- Reply: the reduction loses the performative element, because one can believe a person reliable while refusing to entrust anything to them.
- Second objection: volitional faith is doxastically irresponsible. Reply: the will operates only where evidence is genuinely non-coercive.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The failure-mode row is the decisive one, because a difference in how something can fail is a difference in what it is.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Faith is not a weaker belief; it is a different act, of which belief is one component, and the two come apart in both directions.

10

STAGE 10

AQUINAS: TWO STOREYS AND THE THREE-WAY LOCATION OF FAITH

INTELLECTUAL ASSENT
COMMAND OF THE WILL
GRACE
PREAMBLES
MYSTERIES
MOTIVES OF CREDIBILITY
FIRMNESS WITHOUT VISION
VOLUNTARISM

revealed truth exceeds demonstrative sight -> testimony supplies the object -> the WILL commands the intellect -> GRACE orients the person

KNOWLEDGE firm with sight | FAITH firm without sight | OPINION assent without firmness

THE ACT, AS AQUINAS DEFINES IT

- Faith is an act of the intellect assenting to divine truth under the command of the will moved by grace. Summa Theologiae II-II, questions 1 to 4.
- It is a mean: it has the firmness of knowledge without knowledge's vision, and it lacks opinion's residual fear that the opposite may be true.
- Paraphrase the text; never fabricate an English quotation from it.

THE RECONCILIATION MECHANISM

- Reason establishes the preambles, for example that God exists; revelation supplies the mysteries, for example the Trinity, which are above reason and never against it.
- Because both routes issue from God they cannot genuinely conflict, so an apparent conflict indicates defective reasoning or defective interpretation.
- The hinge is the motives of credibility, which make the assent reasonable although not demonstrative.

THE TWO OBJECTIONS

- Will-governed belief risks voluntarism; the reply is that the will acts only where the evidence is genuinely non-coercive.
- Imported metaphysics may domesticate revelation; the reply is that reason removes contradiction and clarifies implication without generating the mystery.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The 2025 stem asks how the reconciliation works, so the answer must name the two storeys and the hinge rather than describe Aquinas' devotion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aquinas reconciles reason and faith by architecture rather than compromise: reason proves the preambles, revelation supplies the mysteries, and faith is the firm assent that has knowledge's certainty without knowledge's vision.

11

STAGE 11

KIERKEGAARD AND THE PERMISSION LADDER

OBJECTIVE UNCERTAINTY
APPROPRIATION
TELEOLOGICAL SUSPENSION
LIVING, FORCED, MOMENTOUS
PRUDENTIAL ONLY
MANY-GODS OBJECTION
CRITICAL RATIONALISM
INSULATED FIDEISM

STRICTEST -> LOOSEST: Clifford's evidentialism | critical rationalism | James's will-to-believe | Pascal's wager | insulated fideism

Kierkegaard does NOT sit at the loose end: his claim is about WHO must decide, not about how much evidence may be dispensed with

KIERKEGAARD, ACCURATELY STATED

- Faith is passionate, subjective commitment under objective uncertainty; Abraham dramatises the paradox and the teleological suspension of the ethical.
- His target is the claim that an objective philosophical system can replace existential decision.
- He must not be flattened into the view that contradiction, irresponsibility or every evidence-free belief is religiously licensed.

THE PERMISSIONS AND THEIR COSTS

- Clifford's demand disqualifies far more than religion. Critical rationalism permits commitment kept open to criticism, at the cost that nothing is ever finally settled.
- James permits passional decision only where an option is living, forced and momentous and the evidence is genuinely inconclusive; it never licenses belief at will.
- Pascal's wager gives prudential reasons to choose under uncertainty; it supplies no evidence of truth and faces the many-gods and authenticity objections.

THE SLOGAN CONTROL

- The popular formula about believing because a doctrine is absurd is not a safe verbatim quotation from Tertullian.
- Use it only as a later slogan for extreme fideism, and never as Kierkegaard's thesis.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Ordering the positions by how much permission each grants makes the comparison evaluative instead of descriptive, and it fixes Kierkegaard's real location.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kierkegaard's target is not evidence but substitution: he denies that an objective system can be handed to a person in place of the decision only that person can make.

12

STAGE 12

EVIDENTIALISM AGAINST REFORMED EPISTEMOLOGY

ETHICS OF BELIEF
PRESUMPTION OF ATHEISM
CLASSICAL FOUNDATIONALISM
SELF-REFERENTIAL INCOHERENCE
PROPERLY BASIC
WARRANT AND PROPER FUNCTION
GREAT PUMPKIN
SVATAH-PRAMANYA

Locke and Clifford (1877) and Flew -> JAMES (1896) restricts -> PLANTINGA (1983, 2000) five steps -> WARRANT and proper function -> GREAT PUMPKIN -> ALSTON (1991)

VERDICT: justification is internal to a doxastic practice, so the live objection becomes INCOMPATIBLE PRACTICES

THE EVIDENTIALIST DEMAND

- Locke ties assent to the probability of the evidence; Clifford's 'The Ethics of Belief' (1877) makes it a moral matter, illustrated by the shipowner who sends an unseaworthy ship to sea on unexamined hope.
- Flew's presumption of atheism places the burden on the affirmative claim, so the rational default absent sufficient evidence is not-believing rather than agnosticism.
- James (1896) replies that where an option is living, forced and momentous and evidence is genuinely inconclusive the passional nature may lawfully decide, and that Clifford's rule is itself a passional preference for avoiding error over gaining truth.

PLANTINGA'S FIVE STEPS AND THE WARRANT MACHINERY

- The objection presupposes classical foundationalism; that criterion is self-referentially incoherent, being none of the things it demands; it is also too narrow, excluding memory, other minds and beliefs about the past.
- So basicality is not confined to the classical list, and belief in God formed in appropriate circumstances can be properly basic, that is grounded in experience without being inferred.
- Warrant is what turns true belief into knowledge: production by faculties functioning properly, in an appropriate environment, on a design plan aimed at truth. If a sense of the divine (sensus divinitatis) exists and works properly, theistic belief has warrant without argument, so there is no viable de jure objection independent of the de facto question.

THE COUNTER-MOVES AND THE INDIAN ANALOGUES

- Great Pumpkin: if belief in God can be properly basic so can anything. Reply: grounding, defeasibility and disciplined practice. Counter: the criterion becomes community-relative and returns for well-established rival traditions.
- Alston, Perceiving God (1991): no doxastic practice, sense perception included, can be shown reliable without circularity.
- Mimamsa's intrinsic validity (svatah-pramanya) is the closest analogue of proper basicality; Nyaya's extrinsic validity (paratah-pramanya) of evidentialism; Carvaka is the strict evidentialist limit.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The dispute is about the standard of justification rather than the existence of God, and naming that in the first sentence is what separates a scoring script from a wandering one.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religious beliefs can be justified, but not in the way natural theology once hoped: the evidentialist standard taken strictly disqualifies far more than religion, while the Reformed alternative rescues rationality at the price of locating it inside a doxastic practice.

13

STAGE 13

MIRACLES: HUME'S TWO PARTS AND THE FIVE REPLIES

VIOLATION OF A LAW OF NATURE
UNIFORM EXPERIENCE
HUME'S MAXIM
PASSION FOR WONDER
CONTRARY MIRACLES CANCEL
NON-REPEATABLE COUNTER-INSTANCE
PRINCIPLE OF CREDULITY
SIDDHIS ARE OBSTACLES

PART I AND PART II, KEPT SEPARATE

- Hume, Enquiry Concerning Human Understanding, Section X (1748), defines a miracle as a violation of the laws of nature brought about by a particular volition of the Deity.
- Part I: a wise man proportions belief to the evidence; laws rest on uniform experience while testimony rests on non-uniform experience; the weaker must yield; hence the maxim that no testimony suffices unless its falsehood would be more miraculous than the fact, and even then one subtracts the lesser marvel from the greater.
- Part II: never enough witnesses of unquestioned sense, education, integrity and reputation with much to lose; a standing passion for surprise and wonder; provenance among ignorant and barbarous nations; and the mutual cancellation of contrary miracles.

THE FIVE REPLIES AND WHAT SURVIVES

- Definitional: if a law is an exceptionless regularity, a genuine exception shows the law was mis-stated, so Swinburne recasts a miracle as a non-repeatable counter-instance to an otherwise well-confirmed law.
- Evidential: Swinburne's principles of credulity and testimony give memory, perception and report a prima facie right to be believed. Bayesian: Earman, Hume's Abject Failure (2000), separates prior improbability from posterior probability given testimony.
- Circularity, urged by C. S. Lewis and others, and the reply to contrary miracles. What survives is Part II as a checklist of evidential caution; Part I is now widely regarded as too strong.

THE INDIAN CONTRAST, NOT A PARALLEL

- Patanjali's Yoga-sutra Book III catalogues the accomplishments (siddhi or vibhuti) and then at 3.37 declares them obstacles to absorption though accomplishments in the outward-turned state.
- The Kevaddha Sutta, Digha Nikaya 11, has the Buddha reject displays of psychic power as a means of gaining converts, preferring the miracle of instruction.
- Mimamsa grounds Vedic authority in authorless eternality precisely so that it needs no miraculous authentication. Where Western apologetics uses miracles to authenticate, Indian systems mostly decline the strategy.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Keeping the two Parts separate is the structural test the examiner applies, because the replies attach to different Parts and score differently.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hume shows that miracle-testimony faces an unusually heavy evidential burden; he does not show that the burden is in principle unmeetable.

14

STAGE 14

SCIENCE AND RELIGION: BARBOUR'S FOUR MODELS AND THEIR COSTS

CONFLICT
INDEPENDENCE
DIALOGUE
INTEGRATION
WARFARE THESIS REJECTED
NOMA
BOUNDARY QUESTIONS
CONFIRMATION

MODEL	CLAIM AND NAMED ANCHOR	ITS STATED COST
Conflict	competing claims about one world; scientific materialism and scriptural literalism; Draper (1874) and White (1896) supply the warfare thesis	the warfare thesis is now rejected by most historians of science as a polemical nineteenth-century construction
Independence	separate domains, questions and languages; Gould's non-overlapping magisteria, Rocks of Ages (1999)	peace is bought by forbidding either side to say anything the other could contest
Dialogue	distinct but touching at boundary questions and methodological parallels	fruitful but non-committal: it establishes conversation, not conclusions
Integration	natural theology, theology of nature and systematic synthesis such as process thought	hostage to the science of the day; yesterday's integration becomes tomorrow's embarrassment

THE ALTERNATIVE FRAME AND THE NORMATIVE POINT

- Haught's parallel typology is Conflict, Contrast, Contact and Confirmation, the last adding that religion positively supports the scientific enterprise by underwriting the world's intelligibility.
- Religion's continuing significance is normative and existential: technology settles what we can do, not what we should do, and not what a life is for.

THE INDIAN MATERIAL, WHICH IS NOT AN ECHO

- Vivekananda presented Vedanta as the tradition most able to accept scientific findings because it grounds religion in verifiable experience, and described the disciplines of realisation as a science of the soul, which must be reported as a claim rather than endorsed.
- Radhakrishnan treats scientific and religious knowing as levels of one integral experience; Aurobindo's evolutionary metaphysics is an explicit integration model.
- The classical root is whether verbal testimony (sabda) is an independent means of knowledge alongside perception and inference: Carvaka says no, Nyaya and Mimamsa say yes.

THE OBJECTION TO THE TYPOLOGY ITSELF

- The typology is descriptively neat but normatively empty, since it does not say which model is correct.
- The reply is that it classifies positions and the argument must be made model by model, the defensible outcome being a domain-sensitive mixture.
- It also presupposes that science and religion name two stable comparable things, which the historicist critique denies.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The cost column is what converts a memorised typology into an argued verdict, and it is also what prevents the answer collapsing into a narrative.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Neither wholesale conflict nor wholesale independence survives scrutiny, and the defensible position is dialogue at the boundary questions with local conflict only where a religious claim is genuinely empirical.

15

STAGE 15

THE INDIAN BENCH, THE ELEVEN ROUTES AND THE QUALIFIED VERDICT

SABDA AS PRAMANA
SVATAH VERSUS PARATAH
APAURUSEYA
SRAVANA MANANA NIDIDHYASANA
ELEVEN OWNED PYQS
DIRECTIVE DECODER
DEFEATER STATEMENT
NEVER 'BOTH ARE IMPORTANT'

SIX PARITY ROWS -> ELEVEN VERIFIED ROUTES -> 10/15/20 SKELETONS -> SIX-STEP DISCIPLINE -> QUALIFIED VERDICT

FINISH WITH: reason regulates, revelation discloses, faith receives — and name the defeater

THE SIX-ROW PARITY BENCH

- Is testimony independent? Locke and Hume reduce it to experience; Nyaya and Mimamsa make the word (sabda) an independent means of knowledge; Carvaka denies it.
- Is validity intrinsic or extrinsic? Mimamsa's svatah-pramanya against Nyaya's paratah-pramanya is the closest exact parallel in the whole clause.
- Whose speech is scripture? For Mimamsa the Veda is authorless (apauruseya), so India has scriptural authority with no revealer. Faith as trust: sraddha, Gita 17.2-3, and Buddhist saddha, verification-directed. Reason's role: manana, with tarka auxiliary and never independently probative in Vedanta. Miracles: siddhis are obstacles at Yoga-sutra 3.37, so India declines the authentication strategy.

THE ELEVEN VERIFIED OWNER ROUTES, 2019 TO 2025

- 2019 Q5(a) 10m choose faith for reception and reason for regulation; 2020 Q5(a) 10m Barbour with costs then the normative point; 2020 Q7(c) 15m seven tenets then six axes; 2021 Q7(a) 20m regulative is not constitutive.
- 2022 Q5(d) 10m reception rather than occurrence; 2023 Q5(b) 10m name the standard; 2023 Q6(c) 15m add the supra-rational; 2024 Q5(d) 10m four functions plus the limit.
- 2024 Q7(b) 15m six criteria with limits, then rank them yourself; 2025 Q5(e) 10m the two storeys and the hinge; 2025 Q6(c) 15m natural against revealed theology inside the propositional model. Eleven primary-owned parts out of 112 audited; 2018 owns none.

THE ANSWER RAIL AND THE CLOSING DISCIPLINE

- Ten marks: define the term asked, state the internal relation, give one distinction, one objection and a direct verdict. Fifteen: frame the warrant problem, set out the model in steps, give the criteria, add a rival model or the Indian comparison, then objection and reply.
- Twenty: map the three concepts, give the strongest harmony and conflict models, expose presuppositions, meet the competing-revelation and evidential objections, compare Indian and Western positions, and defend a synthesis.
- Six-step discipline: define the disputed term; say whether the issue is source, reception, warrant or commitment; reconstruct one named position; add the strongest objection and reply; use one exact Indian comparison; end with a graded verdict and the defeater that would change it.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Every directive printed on this clause rewards a decision, so the closing sentence must decide and then name what would overturn the decision.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rational religion is neither proof without trust nor trust without criticism: faith may go beyond coercive proof, but it forfeits philosophical standing when it claims a right to go against reason or exemption from correction.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

PUBLIC VERSUS PRIVATE TESTIMONY
DOXASTIC VOLUNTARISM
APAURUSEYA AS REVELATION?
FULL WARRANT MACHINERY
SPECIALIST TESTIMONY THEORY

SECOND-ORDER DEBATES

- Public communal testimony and credibility signs against first-person disclosure received in interpretive faith; competing revelations are said to cancel, and the reply is that warrant is defeasible and cumulative, forcing comparative assessment rather than collapse.
- Doxastic voluntarism against involuntarism: traditions usually mean indirect control through attention, trust, practice and consent to inquiry, not instantaneous arbitrary choice.

RESIDUE AFTER THE 2026 PROMOTION

- Reformed epistemology against evidentialism was promoted to Core on 15 August 2026 and is taught in the core rail, so only the full warrant and proper-function machinery and the question whether the Great Pumpkin objection is answered or merely deflected remain optional.
- Whether authorlessness (apauruseya) counts as revelation in its own right, and specialist testimony theory, are recorded as still awaiting a promotion trigger.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This card is subordinate enrichment and is unnecessary for a competent core answer.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels